Blessed are the Confused – A Collection

By Clayton Jennings

INTRODUCTION

What happens when someone grows up in a church that promises love and guidance but instead leaves them feeling judged, confused, and alone? "Goodbye Religion" follows a narrator who has spent years trying to find God, only to feel let down by hypocrisy, unanswered prayers, and church leaders who care more about power than people. "Church Hurt" shows how a teenager loses trust in church because the adults act holy in public but hide serious problems at home. Church communities, when their actions don't match their message, often push young people to question what they believe and what real faith should look like.

Blessed are the Confused – A Collection by Clayton Jennings

Goodbye Religion

How do I describe you when my words come from the
mouth of a spiritual infant?
I read the letters and fell in love with the miracles in it.
And I get a picture of you from the pictures portrayed in
the snapshots of Scripture . . .

4NG Fanatics

I've hung pictures of you on my wall, and I stared
with doubt.
I don't know if you look like the pictures we portray you to
be.
What's my purpose, God? What did you create me to be?
I'm dying for you to show up and just say it to me.

I'm only thirty, but the weight of this stress pushes so hard
on my chest
And sometimes, I literally feel like I can't breathe.
You said I'd have peace and joy, but that can't be
Because I'm so sick of church politics and religious greed,
I had to take back my life.

I don't want you, and I don't need you.
I've spent my whole life looking for you, but I still can't see
you.
And maybe that's because you're invisible
I hope you're enjoying Heaven, because down here I'm
miserable.

In Sunday school, they told me Jesus loves the little
children.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

So where were you in Parkland when that gunman showed up to kill them?
I guess you had the day off, didn't you, Jesus?
I'm doubting everything these fake pastors feed us.
You do nothing when radicals attack us and beat us.
Do you even care about the way that they treat us?
It's like you turn a blind eye, and you don't even need us.
My eyes are far from blind, and I'm not turning or shutting them.
I've spent 30 years of my life with my nose in your book, just studying
And where did that ever get me except confused and anxious?
Half of what I read felt aloof and ancient.
Your Holy Book was written 2000 years ago.

I sat in the pews scared as a kid, and my tears would flow
And I prayed for dad to be healed with a miracle.
You turned water into wine, but in my eyes, you couldn't take that water from mine.
You never came to save the day, and everything dad built for 35 years, you had double-minded men take away.

4NG Fanatics

And I know they'll get theirs someday, but I'd rather slit my throat than sit under another corrupt elder board Monday to Sunday.

I grew up in a cult, and I got told you're everything. You're not.
And I'm standing here right now with everything that I got
And I don't have much to offer you.
As a kid, I'd sit under that preaching and doze off in the pew
And I'd wake up to people picking me up and passing me around
"He's gonna grow up to be the next Billy Graham," they'd say around town.
But every one of those fakes bailed on me when I was down.
A church pew kid who found out religion is nothing but a cult.
When I woke up, I split from that place like Usain Bolt.
And I left the wannabe-elect and ran to the only thing I believed to be true.

I'm here right now telling you what you need to do.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

I need you to erase every memory of that place and the lies I was taught.

And if you want me to be strong, I can try, but I'm not.

I need you to rescue me from everything I saw as a church pew kid . . .

Jesus, take my old thoughts about you, and cleanse me.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Clayton Jennings
Spoken Word Album: Goodbye Religion, Track 8
ISBN: Digital Album
(Check publication requirements for your tournament before performing)
Publisher: 897065 Records DK
Date (Month/Year): June 2018

Lyrics available online at: https://genius.com/Clayton-jennings-goodbye-religion-lyrics

Church Hurt

Wake up, shake up, get ready for church!

We found the right one after a two-month search.

We like this pastor 'cause he doesn't curse

Our last pastor was the worst

He was so self-righteous.

Satan tempted us, and we were like try us.

4NG Fanatics

We're the perfect family, eye us --

Mister and misses pious

And we go to church in our nice little Prius.

First at the potluck, there if you need us.

And when the offering plate gets passed, we promise you'll see us.

Look at how bad these heathens wanna be us.

We love our money, in God we trust.

Big donation means our name on the bus.

Look at us, look at us,

We don't go to church to worship, we go for the rush

We live two houses down from the church.

My mom works in the lobby and sells their merch.

Welcome to the Holy Church of Jesus the Nazarene Christ

If you donate enough money, it'll change your life.

I'm trying to figure out my own

In and out of boys' homes.

Almost 18, can't wait to get treated like I'm grown.

Hated church ever since Dad left us alone.

He ran off with a deacon's wife who lived down the road.

And this Sunday, yeah, it's Father's Day.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

It's gonna be awkward and odd to stay.

And I know fifty people are gonna come up to pray

"Lord, take their pain away"

But it'll stay right where it is.

My breathing gets heavy, and I ball up my fists.

I'm done worshipping Jesus. . .

So look at me, what's the matter?

I'm the guy four rows back getting yelled at by the pastor.

Little does he know, my homelife's a disaster.

Why can't he tell me about who I am in God?

Why does he always have to tell me who I'm not?

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Clayton Jennings
Spoken Word Album: King Nothing, Track 2
ISBN: Digital Album
(Check publication requirements for your tournament before performing)
Publisher: 897065 Records DK
Date (Month/Year): May 2019

Lyrics available online at: https://genius.com/Clayton-jennings-church-hurt-lyrics

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

4NG Fanatics